



IEEE SIGNAL PROCESSING SOCIETY AWARD ENDORSEMENT FORM

Who is Not Eligible to Serve as an Endorser for an IEEE Signal Processing Society Award nominee?

No member of the IEEE Signal Processing Society Awards Board or IEEE Signal Processing Society Board of Governors, for specified awards only. See award descriptions for details. Only individuals are allowed to provide endorsements. Endorsements from boards/committees will not be accepted. Nominations by individuals can be accompanied by up to two endorsements by other individual members. Nominations supported by committees/boards cannot be accompanied by endorsements. Members of a committee/board may participate as individual endorsers for other members of the same board/committee. In addition, a nominator may not serve as an endorser for a nomination he/she is submitting. IEEE staff cannot serve as an endorser.

Who is Eligible to Serve as Endorser for an IEEE Signal Processing Society Award nominee? To be an endorser, there is no requirement for IEEE Signal Processing Society membership. Endorsement forms can be submitted by any individual for an IEEE Signal Processing Society award nomination.

Instructions for Preparing the IEEE Signal Processing Society Award Endorsement Form

An endorsement form is an important contribution to the IEEE Signal Processing Society Awards Board's decision whether to recommend/select a nominee for an IEEE Signal Processing Society Award. Endorsers must cite specific evidence of the uniqueness and impact of the individual's contributions to the Society or the signal processing field or the contributions of the nominated paper. Nonspecific comments, such as this person or work is outstanding, without identifying a substantial contribution to professional knowledge, widely used technologies, or industry processes, products and services, are of no value. Comments about the relative contributions by the nominee to any work attributed to more than the nominee, for example, if the nominee is a co-author of a listed work, are of value.

A nomination for an IEEE Signal Processing Society Award nominee **is limited to two (2) endorsements. If more than two endorsements are submitted, only the first two submitted endorsements will be considered by the IEEE Signal Processing Society Awards Board. Endorsements can only be up to two-pages in length. Endorsements must be submitted on or before the nomination deadline of 1 September.**



IEEE SIGNAL PROCESSING SOCIETY
AWARD ENDORSEMENT FORM

1. NAME OF NOMINEE:	Gupta	Rahul		
	Last Name (Family)	First	Middle	Prefix
2. NOMINATED AWARD:	IEEE Signal Processing Society Industrial Innovation Award			
3. NAME OF NOMINATOR:	Lee	Chi-Chun	Prof.	
	Last Name (Family)	First	Middle	Prefix
4. NAME OF ENDORSER:	Cevher	Volkan	Prof.	
	Last Name (Family)	First	Middle	Prefix
	EPFL, Laboratory for Information and Inference Systems, ELE 233, Station 11			
	Organization's Name and Mailing Address			
	1015 Lausanne, Switzerland			
	City State/Province Zip/Postal Code Country			
	Email: volkan.cevher@epfl.ch; Tel: +41 21 693 11 01; IEEE Fellow			
	Telephone #/Fax #/E-mail/IEEE Member #			

4. Describe your relationship to the nominee and how you, PERSONALLY, became aware of the importance of his/her extraordinary accomplishment/paper and its impact on society/field. **(not more than 100 words)**

I worked closely with Rahul on LLM unlearning during my time as an Amazon Scholar / collaborator with Amazon AGI. Through that collaboration, I saw how he connected rigorous academic research with production-facing Responsible AI needs. Our work helped produce public research artifacts including LUME and the SemEval-2025 Unlearning Challenge, which drew over 100 submissions from researchers across more than 30 institutions.

5. On the basis of your personal knowledge of the work of the nominee, please indicate whether or not, in your judgment, the nominee meets the requirements for a Signal Processing Society award. What distinguishes his/her paper or contributions from the norm? If not a paper award, explain from your perspective (not copied from the nomination form), the impact on professional knowledge, widely used technologies, or industry processes, products, and services of at least one outstanding contribution made by the nominee as it pertains to the award. How does the nominee's accomplishment compare with those of past recipients of the award whom you are familiar (not naming individuals)? Has the nominee's contribution made a significant difference to society, and, if so, how? **(not more than 300 words)**

Rahul Gupta meets the requirements for this award because he has demonstrated a rare ability to merge academic research with production-scale Responsible AI practice. I observed this directly through our collaboration on LLM unlearning at Amazon AGI. Unlearning is a technically difficult problem: it requires removing sensitive, copyrighted, or private content from large language models while preserving general model utility. What impressed me most was Rahul's ability to take a concrete production need - removing sensitive or unwanted knowledge from large language models without full retraining - and turn it into public research infrastructure, including the LUME benchmark and the SemEval-2025 unlearning challenge. Rahul helped organize this challenge with academic and industry collaborators; it received over 100 submissions and involved researchers from more than 30 institutions. This is exactly the kind of ecosystem-building that distinguishes Rahul: he does not only solve Responsible AI problems inside one company, but creates mechanisms through which the broader research community can study, evaluate, and improve frontier AI systems. Rahul has also been highly effective at securing and directing industry support for academic research. He has helped connect Amazon resources and funding to university collaborations, workshops, challenges, and shared benchmarks in Responsible AI. In my judgment, this combination of technical depth, production relevance, and community-building makes his contributions unusually strong for the IEEE SPS Industrial Innovation Award.

6. Provide a brief listing of your own credentials. **(not more than 100 words)**

Volkan Cevher is Full Professor at EPFL and head of the Laboratory for Information and Inference Systems. He is an IEEE Fellow for contributions to model-based signal processing and semi-definite programming, an ELLIS Fellow, and recipient of ERC Starting and Consolidator Grants and multiple best-paper awards.